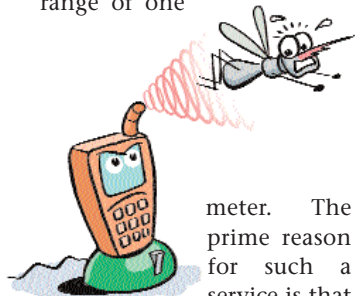


Ring out the pests?

A new service allows cell phone users to download a sound that repels troublesome mosquitoes by South Korea's top mobile phone operator. According to SK Telecom, the sound is capable of clearing the insects within a range of one



meter. The prime reason for such a service is that mosquitoes are a common irritant during the hot, humid summers in Korea.

Subscribers of the service will be able to download the sound, which will cost 3,000 won (\$2.54), from the firm's wireless Internet service from 21st July. The sound plays constantly, consuming precious mobile battery charge. It is faintly audible to the human ear.

Repelling the bugs will use up to 30 per cent more of the phone's battery power, said SK, which controls more than half of Asia's third-largest mobile market.

Critical flaw found in Windows

Microsoft announced three new security breaches in its software, including one 'critical' Windows flaw that allows a hacker to run any unauthorised code on victims' PCs. The flaw known as a buffer overrun vulnerability allows an attacker to use an unchecked buffer to run their own executable code. The flaw located in the HTML converter in Windows, is used by hackers to spread the code either by sending an HTML e-mail or by creating a special Web page that triggers a the code.

The vulnerability exists in most recent versions of Win-



dows, including Windows XP, 2000, 98, 98 SE, Me, and NT 4.0 Server. The flaw is less effective in Windows Server 2003, because it ships with a setting known as Enhanced Security Configuration designed to minimise the risk of unauthorised code being launched. Microsoft has posted a patch for the vulnerability on its Web site.

Hijacked PCs spread porn

Two thousand Windows-based PCs with high-speed Internet connections in San Francisco have been hijacked by a stealth program and are being used to send ads for pornography, say computer security experts. The Trojan, dubbed 'Migmaf' or 'migrant Mafia', turns the victim computer into a proxy server that serves as a sort of middleman between people clicking on porn e-mail spam or Web site

links. It allows the victim computer to fetch porn Web ads from an undisclosed server and pass the ads on to other computers, either through an e-mail spam or a Web browser.

The Trojan is also said to be responsible for a PayPal scam discovered last week. Designed to collect credit card information from people who filled in a form they received via e-mail claiming to be from Web payment provider PayPal.

quoteworthy

"For folks who want the ultimate experience, they'll want the latest ATI card, and the fastest processor available from AMD or Intel."

Marketing Director for Valve, Doug Lombardi, talking about *Half-Life 2*'s release

"Google's a very nice system, but compared to my vision, it's pathetic."

Microsoft Executive, Jim Allchin, talking about their new search program called MSNBot that trawls the Net, and builds an index of HTML links, and documents

"Like almost everyone, I receive a lot of spam every day, much of it offering to help me get out of debt or get rich quick"

Microsoft Chairman, Bill Gates, pointing out that spam is draining business productivity and that Microsoft alone cannot fix the problem

snapshot

Spam filters on Microsoft's MSN and Hotmail e-mail services now block 2.4 billion messages a day

Source: MSN

tomorrow's technology

SoundVu... audio/visual integration at its finest

SoundVu is a technology under development by NXT. The technology aims at producing audio and visual output from a single surface. By doing this, NXT aims to provide a speaker with virtually no footprint.

Due to its technology and size, SoundVu panels can bet-

ter standard phone receiver systems. The sound quality provided by such a panel is much higher than a regular receiver. But the best advantage of this would be a dramatic change in the shape and design of the phone. This is mainly due to the integration of the audio and video units.

Such technology would also be very useful in high end multimedia phones. The SoundVu technology meets the needs of 3G handsets. NEC is one of the first electronic giants to have shown interest in this system. It has developed a laptop with a screen that works as a speaker.